



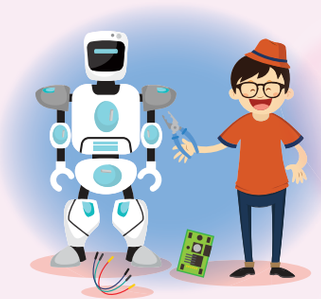
Speak gently to the aged one,
Grieve not the care-worn heart;
The sands of life are nearly run,
Let such in peace **depart!**

Speak gently, kindly, to the poor;
Let no harsh tone be heard;
They have enough they must **endure,**
Without an unkind word!





Speak gently to the erring – know,
They may have **toiled** in **vain;**
Perchance unkindness made them so;
Oh, win them back again!



Speak gently! – He who gave his life
To bend man's **stubborn** will,
When elements were in fierce **strife,**
Said to them, 'Peace, be still.'



Speak gently! – 'tis a little thing
Dropped in the heart's deep well;
The good, the joy, which it may bring,
Eternity shall tell.

David Bates



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